

Task: Differentiate RAM/Cache/Persistent Storage
The Flow

CPU $\rightarrow$ Cache $\rightarrow$ RAM $\rightarrow$ SSD/HDD

Cache: Keep frequently needed data close to CPU

RAM: Hold programs/data currently being used

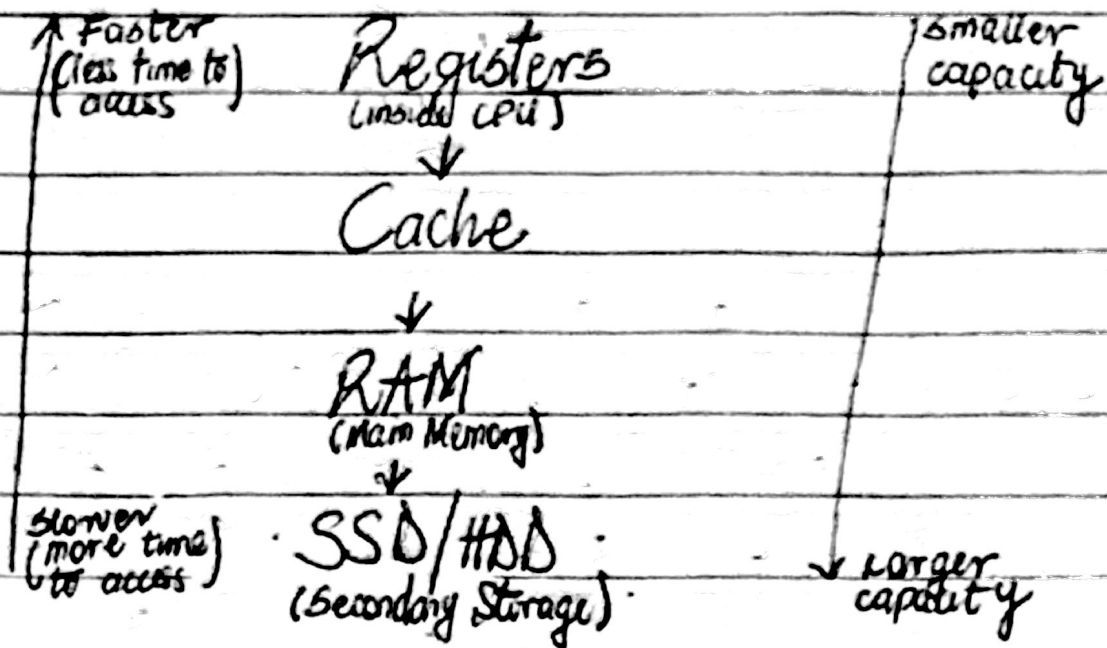
Persistent Storage: Keep data permanently

RAM & Cache are both volatile memory: they lose their contents when power is removed

SSD/HDD is persistent storage; files remain there after you shut down the computer

TASK

MEMORY Hierarchy



The closer the memory is to the CPU, the faster it is, but the smaller it is and more expensive per GB. The farther it is, the slower it is but the larger the capacity.